PRD: Read the Bible With Me (working title)

Version 1.0 · Android first (iOS later) · Individual users only · Google sign-in only · Subscription with free trial via Google Play

1. Vision

An app that puts Scripture before the scroll. Users lock their distracting apps, choose what part of the Bible they want to finish and by when, and the app unlocks their phone only after they read that day's portion. Shorter deadline means more daily readings.

One-liner: *Read the Bible before you scroll.*

Problem: Many Christians want to read the Bible daily but never do. Willpower alone fails, and nothing in their day makes them.

Solution: Turn the phone habit that steals their time into the trigger for Scripture, paced to a goal they chose.

Why this can win - A faith app with a built-in habit loop (the lock) retains better than a reading app that depends on reminders. - Christian users already pay for faith apps, and intent is high. - Competitors lock apps behind prayer. We win on **goal-based Bible reading**: pick a scope, pick a deadline, and see a real plan with a finish date. - Priced below the main competitor ($4.99/week vs their $9.99, $39.99/year vs their ~$50).

2. Principles

1. **Scripture first.** Everything in the app serves reading the Word. No feature clutter.
2. **Gentle, not guilt.** Encouraging tone, never shaming. Missed days get "Let's pick this up today."
3. **Honest persuasion.** Use psychology (commitment, personalization, reflection), but no fake numbers, fake reviews or false promises. Only claim what is true.
4. **Never trap the user.** Emergency access always works, and if the subscription ends, every lock is removed immediately.
5. **Minimal design.** Calm, warm, uncluttered.

3. Target users

- Christians aged 18–40 in the **US and India**, English first
- Want a daily Bible habit but struggle with consistency

- Spend 2+ hours a day on social apps
- Denominations: Catholic, Orthodox, Protestant, Baptist, Pentecostal, Anglican, Evangelical, Non-denominational and others

4. Goals and success metrics

Metric	Target
Onboarding completion (open → paywall)	≥ 50%
Paywall → trial start	≥ 20%
Trial → paid	≥ 35–45%
Day-7 retention	≥ 30%
Day-30 retention	≥ 15%
Plan completion	≥ 20% of users finish a chosen plan
Play Store rating	≥ 4.5
Revenue goal	$1k/month: about 60 active weekly payers at $4.99 (≈ $4.24 net after Google's 15%), or a mix with annual

5. Core mechanic: goal-based pacing

User picks: what to read, and by when.

What to read	Chapters (approx.)	Total reading time
Gospels	89	~4 hrs
New Testament	260	~13 hrs
Old Testament	929	~55 hrs
Whole Bible	1,189	~70 hrs
Psalms and Proverbs	181	~9 hrs
A single book	varies	varies

Calculation - Daily load = remaining reading time ÷ remaining days, weighted by word count (a long chapter counts for more). - One **reading session** is about 5 minutes (roughly 2 chapters). - **Locks per day** = daily load ÷ session size, rounded up. - A shorter deadline means more locks per day.

Example	Per day	Locks/day
Gospels in 60 days	~1.5 ch	1
Gospels in 30 days	~3 ch	2
New Testament in 90 days	~3 ch	2
Whole Bible in 365 days	~3.3 ch	2
Whole Bible in 90 days	~13 ch	6 (cap)

Rules - **Cap of 6 locks per day.** If the goal needs more, warn the user and suggest a longer timeline. - **Falling behind:** the plan recalculates daily from what's left. Show "You're 2 days behind. Today you have 3 readings." and offer to extend the deadline. - **Spacing:** the first lock appears the first time a locked app is opened that day. Each later lock appears after the previous unlock window ends (about 2–3 hours). - **Unlock window:** 30 or 60 minutes (user setting). Completing a session unlocks all chosen apps. - **Never blocked:** calls, messages, maps, emergency and phone-essential apps. A "skip today" option always exists.

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6. Features

P0: MVP

1. Google sign-in (Firebase Auth)
2. Full onboarding quiz (section 7)
3. Plan engine with preview and finish date
4. App lock overlay over chosen apps
5. Reading screen: serif Scripture, minimum read time, "I've read this" at the end
6. Unlock windows
7. Home: today's progress, streak, plan progress bar
8. Streaks with one grace day per week
9. Daily reminders and trial-ending reminder
10. Daily spiritual check-in (section 9)
11. Translations: WEB, KJV, Douay-Rheims (public domain), with offline reading
12. Subscription with free trial through Google Play Billing (section 8)
13. Emergency access and skip-today

P1: Soon after launch

- Short plain-language explanation after each passage
- Reflection question and private journal
- Journal calendar and weekly reflection
- Audio mode
- Verse card sharing (image for Instagram and WhatsApp)
- Change or pause a plan, add a second plan
- Hindi UI and Hindi Bible, then Malayalam, Tamil, Telugu
- Home-screen widget

P2: Later

- iOS version (Apple Screen Time API)
- Memory-verse flashcards
- Gamified companion (for example a sheep that grows as you read)
- Church and group features with a leader dashboard (deliberately out of scope for v1)
- Prayer requests, sermon notes, family mode

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7. Onboarding flow

One question per screen, quiz style. Easy questions first, so users invest effort before the paywall.

#	Screen	Purpose
1	**Welcome:** "Put God before the scroll."	Promise
2	**Why are you here?** Grow closer to God · Build a daily habit · Understand Scripture · Going through a hard season	Personalization, emotional buy-in
3	**Your denomination:** Catholic · Orthodox · Protestant · Baptist · Pentecostal · Anglican · Evangelical · Non-denominational · Other · Prefer not to say	Picks the right canon and translation
4	**Gender** (optional): Male · Female · Prefer not to say	Light personalization of suggested plans and wording
5	**How much time do you spend on your phone daily?** Slider, 1–10+ hrs	Starts the reflection
6	**The reveal**	See below
7	**How often do you read the Bible now?** Never · Rarely · Sometimes · Weekly	Calibrates the plan
8	**What do you want to read, and by when?**	Pacing engine
9	**Plan preview:** "2 readings a day. Finish by 14 Dec."	Makes it concrete
10	**Which apps steal your time?**	Chooses locked apps
11	**Commitment:** press and hold "I'm ready to put God first"	Commitment effect
12	**Permissions:** accessibility, overlay, usage access, each with a plain-language reason	Needed for the lock
13	**Notifications:** pre-prompt ("Want a gentle reminder each day? We'll also tell you before your trial ends."), then the system dialog only if they say yes	Higher acceptance
14	**Sign in with Google**	Ties subscription to the account
15	**Trial journey screen** (extra screen 1)	Shows how the 7 days will go
16	**Why it works screen** (extra screen 2)	Builds belief before the ask
17	**Paywall**	Section 8
18	**Home**	Begin

How denomination and gender are used

- **Catholic:** offer Catholic canon (Douay-Rheims, including the deuterocanonical books).
- **Orthodox:** Septuagint-based order where available.
- **Protestant, Baptist, Evangelical, others:** standard 66-book Bible.
- Suggested plans adapt (for example liturgical readings for Catholic users).
- **Gender:** optional, used only to suggest plans ("Women of the Bible," "Men of Faith") and wording. Never shown to others, never used for ads. The screen says why it's asked.
- "Prefer not to say" gets neutral defaults.

Screen 6: the reveal

Turn the user's own answer into a reflection. Example for 4 hours a day:

> **4 hours a day = 1,460 hours a year.** That's **61 full days** on your phone. The whole Bible takes about **70 hours** to read. Just **5% of your phone time** would get you through it, and you'd finish it about 20 times over with the rest.

- Show an animated bar: a large gold bar for phone time and a small green bar for "the whole Bible."
- Also show the per-plan version once they choose (Gospels ≈ 4 hrs, New Testament ≈ 13 hrs).
- Label the numbers as estimates. No guilt language. The tone is "imagine what's possible."

Screen 15: your 7-day journey (extra screen 1)

A personalized timeline built from their plan:

- **Day 1:** Your plan starts. First reading done, first unlock.
- **Day 3:** First streak. "You've read X chapters."
- **Day 5:** We remind you your trial ends in 2 days.
- **Day 7:** "You'll have read about X chapters of [their plan] and built a 7-day habit." Billing starts only if you keep going, and you can cancel anytime in Google Play.

Honest wording: promise the habit and the chapters read, which the app controls. Don't promise a guaranteed spiritual outcome.

Screen 16: why it works (extra screen 2)

- A short line on the idea: small, daily reading beats occasional long sessions.
- Three simple points: "Scripture before scrolling," "A plan you can actually finish," "A gentle daily check-in with God."
- Use real social proof only (real reviews or real user counts once they exist). Before launch, leave it out. Do not invent review counts or "#1" claims.

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8. Paywall and pricing

Model: hard paywall. The user must start the trial to enter the app. No free tier.

Plan	US	India (suggested, test)
Weekly	**$4.99/week**	₹99/week
Annual	**$39.99/year** (about $0.77/week)	₹1,499/year
Free trial	7 days on both plans	7 days on both plans

Notes: - Competitor reference: $9.99/week and about $50/year. Our pricing undercuts both while still earning well. - Annual is about 85% cheaper per week, so show "Save 85%" on it and consider selecting it by default. - A 3-day trial on the weekly plan converts to paid more often than a 7-day one. Start with 7 days and A/B test 3 days. - India pricing is set per country in Google Play. ₹ prices are a starting point to test, since $4.99 (~₹420) per week is high for most Indian users.

Paywall screen - Headline: "Start your 7-day free trial" - Their plan: "Gospels in 30 days · 2 readings a day" - Three benefits: app lock, a plan you'll finish, daily check-in and journal - Two plan cards (weekly and annual) with "7 days free" and "No payment now" on the trial - Clear text: "7 days free, then $4.99/week (or $39.99/year). Cancel anytime in Google Play." - Primary button: **Start free trial** - Small links: Restore purchases, Terms, Privacy - Visual: a warm sunrise or landscape header image in the app's palette

Google Play requirements - Show price, trial length, renewal period and how to cancel on the paywall itself, in readable text. - Use Google Play Billing only. - Handle all subscription states: trial, active, grace period, account hold, cancelled, expired.

Entitlement rules - App checks entitlement at launch. No active trial or subscription means the paywall. - **Lapsed subscription removes all locks immediately.**

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9. Daily spiritual check-in

A short, optional check-in about the user's walk with God.

When: after the day's last reading, or any time from Home. Always skippable ("Not today"), and skipping never affects streaks or unlocking.

Flow (about 30 seconds) 1. **How connected do you feel to God today?** Distant · Dry · Okay · Close · Very close 2. **How are you feeling?** (pick any) Grateful · Peaceful · Anxious · Tired · Struggling · Joyful · Guilty · Lonely · Hopeful 3. **Anything on your heart?** Optional note: "A prayer, a worry, or a thank-you. Only you can see this." 4. **A response:** one fitting verse and a one-line encouragement - Anxious → 1 Peter 5:7 - Distant or dry → James 4:8, Psalm 63:1 - Grateful → Psalm 107:1 - Struggling → Matthew 11:28

Journal: a calendar with a colored dot per day, tap to read a past note. Weekly reflection (P1): "You felt closest to God on Sunday and Wednesday."

Privacy and care - Private by default and never shared. - Users can export or delete everything. - Not used for ads. - **Crisis safeguard:** if a note suggests self-harm or crisis, show a gentle message encouraging them to talk to someone they trust, with a helpline for their country. The app never claims to be counseling or a replacement for a pastor or professional care. Include a clear disclaimer.

10. Daily user flows

Daily lock: Open Instagram → lock screen: "Reading 1 of 2 · John 1–2 · about 5 min" → read → "I've read this" → Instagram opens for 60 min.

Behind schedule: Home shows a gentle banner → "Catch up today or extend your deadline."

End of day: last reading done → optional check-in → streak updated.

11. Design system

Style: minimal, light mode only, warm and calm.

Role	Color
Background	Cream `#FAF6EA`
Cards	White `#FFFFFF`
Primary button	Yellow `#F5C842`
Highlights, borders	Gold `#B8913A`
Progress, success	Green `#4F7A4A`
Text	Black `#1A1A1A` (secondary `#5C5648`)

- **Type:** serif for Scripture (Lora or Source Serif), clean sans for the interface (Inter).
- **Layout:** generous spacing, rounded cards, one primary button per screen, thin gold dividers.
- **Motif:** a subtle cross or olive branch, used sparingly.
- **Imagery:** soft sunrise or landscape photography, mainly on the welcome and paywall screens.
- **Tone:** warm and encouraging. "How is your heart today?" over clinical wording.

12. Screens

Welcome · 9 quiz screens · Reveal · Plan preview · Apps · Commitment · Permissions · Notifications · Sign-in · Trial journey · Why it works · Paywall · Home · Reading · Lock overlay · Check-in (3 steps and response) · Journal · Plan and progress · Settings

13. Technical

- **App:** Android, Flutter or Kotlin (the lock needs native code)
- **Blocking:** Accessibility Service or UsageStats plus overlay permission
- **Backend:** Firebase: Auth (Google), Firestore (profile, plans, progress, check-ins), Cloud Messaging (reminders), Cloud Functions
- **Bible data:** WEB, KJV and Douay-Rheims bundled locally for offline use

- **Billing:** Google Play Billing Library, subscription with weekly and annual base plans and a 7-day trial offer
- **Verification:** server-side through the Google Play Developer API and real-time developer notifications (Cloud Function), with entitlement stored in Firestore
- **Analytics:** Firebase Analytics. Track each onboarding step, paywall views, trial starts, conversions and daily retention

Data model (Firestore) - `users` : denomination, gender, goal, phone-time answer, plan, locked apps, settings - `plans` : scope, start date, end date, daily load, progress - `readings` : date, passage, completed time - `checkins` : date, connection (1–5), feelings, note, verse shown - `entitlements` : status, expiry, product

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14. Privacy

- Denomination, gender, phone-time answer, check-ins and notes are sensitive. Use strict Firestore security rules, a clear privacy policy, and in-app explanations for each question.
- Users can edit or delete their data at any time.
- No selling or sharing of data, no ads.
- Disclose Accessibility Service use clearly in the app and on the Play listing.

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15. Risks and compliance

Risk	Mitigation
Google Play restricts Accessibility use	Clear in-app explanation, policy disclosure, least-invasive approach
Phone makers kill background apps (Xiaomi, Samsung, OnePlus)	Per-brand setup guide, test on several devices
Play rejects the paywall or subscription disclosure	Show price, trial and renewal clearly and follow the subscription policy
Weekly billing causes refunds and bad reviews	Trial-ending reminder on day 5, clear cancel path, easy support contact
Unverifiable claims ("#1," review counts, user counts)	Use only true, current numbers
Hard paywall lowers trial starts	A/B test trial length and a soft downsell offer later
Users uninstall to escape the lock	Short sessions, a grace day, gentle tone
Overloaded plans cause burnout	Cap of 6 locks per day and a suggested minimum timeline
Translation licensing	Public-domain translations only for v1
Sensitive data (denomination, gender, notes)	Strict rules, privacy policy, delete/export, crisis safeguard
Strong competitors	Win on goal-based plans, lower price and a calmer design

16. Roadmap

Phase	Duration
Design, Bible data, pricing setup in Play Console	1–2 weeks
Blocking prototype and plan engine	2–3 weeks
Onboarding, paywall, billing, reading, home, streaks	3 weeks
Check-in, reminders, polish	1–2 weeks
Closed beta with 20–30 users	3–4 weeks
Play Store launch	after beta
iOS, Hindi, P1 features	after launch

17. Open questions

1. Trial length: 7 days or 3 days (test both)?
2. Pre-select annual or weekly on the paywall?
3. Final India pricing (₹99/week and ₹1,499/year are starting points)?
4. App name and brand
5. Which Hindi Bible translation to license or use